The journal

Above: ARCHITECTURE.md §4.6.

Talks to:

- the front door (`/journal/`);
- the desk, whose scheduler starts each account's sync;
- the data sources: Alpaca fills and orders, and bars;
- the shared record: the facts, the market state and the R1 row known at a trade's entry;
- qp: the chart of a trade;
- its own file.

---

1. What it is

Every real trade, after the fact: what was bought and sold, at what prices, in what size, against what stop, under what market, for what result. Then the patterns across trades: by hour, weekday, price, size, side and setup.

It answers the question the tools' records do not: **how do my actual trades go?** The tools' records measure what the screeners find; the journal measures what the trader did with it.

It is its own program, with its own file, because it shares nothing live with the tools.

What it owns:

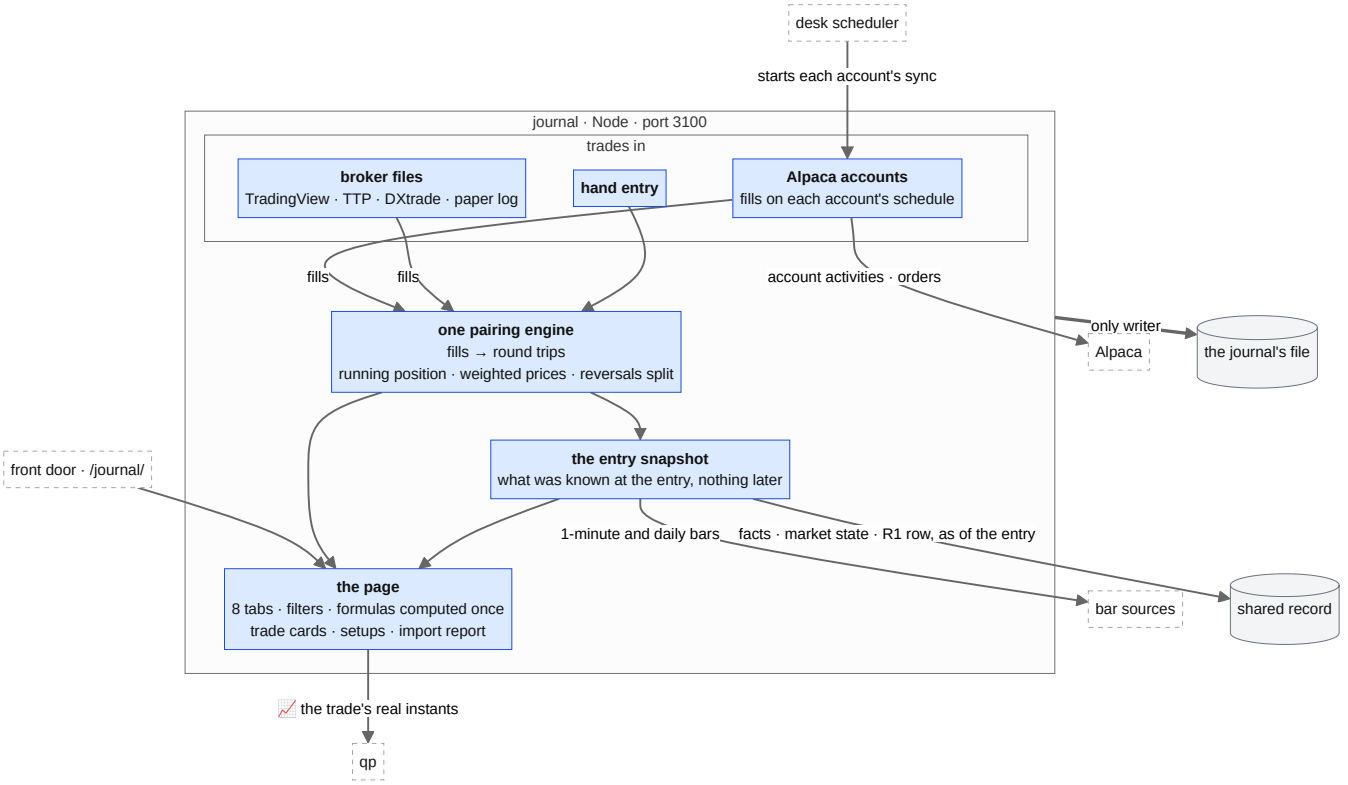
- the accounts;
- the fills;
- the trades, with their fills, stops, fees, setups and notes;
- each trade's snapshot at its entry;
- the day notes.

What it never does:

- place an order: the desk places none;
- grade or size a trade for execution;
- keep a timer of its own: each sync is started by the desk.

---

2. The diagram



3. Its parts

Part	Job	Detail
trades in	the three ways a trade arrives: Alpaca accounts synced on a schedule; broker files uploaded by the trader; hand entry. Each produces **fills**	IMPORT.md
the pairing engine	one engine, for every source, turns fills into round trips. It handles scale-ins, scale-outs, reversals and open positions once, with stable ids, so a second import updates and never duplicates	IMPORT.md
stops and fees	the stop from the broker's stop order, the strategy's exit plan, or the trader; fees from the broker, or from the account's fee rule (labelled estimated)	IMPORT.md
the entry snapshot	the price structure from bars up to the entry minute; the facts, the market state and the R1 row as known at the entry; MAE and MFE between the entry and the exit	REVIEW.md
the page	eight tabs (Overview, Calendar, Time, Risk, Stats, Setups, Trades, Import) and three filters; every number computed in one place; the trade cards; the setup statistics; the 📈 chart link	REVIEW.md

4. Contracts

The program: Node, `journal/server.js`, on port 3100 of the box, behind the front door at `/journal/`.

It owns the journal's file, `data/journal/journal.db`. The target tables are below. Today the trades live in `journal_trades`, with the setups, day notes and fee profiles; the old app's leftover tables are not carried (FILES.md §3.5).

Table	Key
`accounts` (keys in the secret file `data/journal/journal-accounts.json`)	id
`fills`	account, external id
`trades`	id (stable)
`trade_fills`	trade, fill, portion
`setups`	id
`trade_snapshots`	trade
`day_notes`	day

It reads	From
account activities (fills) and orders	Alpaca, per account
1-minute and daily bars	the bar sources (SOURCES.md)
facts, the market state and the R1 row, as of the entry	the shared record

Routes, behind `/journal/`	Do
`GET /api/journal/trades` (filters); `GET /api/journal/trades/:id`	trades; one trade with its fills and its snapshot
`PATCH /api/journal/trades/:id`; `POST /api/journal/trades`	stop, target, fees, setup, notes, tags; hand entry
`POST /api/journal/import`	a file in, an import report back
`GET/POST/DELETE /api/journal/accounts…`, `…/test`, `…/fetch`	accounts; no secret is ever returned
`POST /api/journal/sync` (to build)	one sync of the due accounts, started by the desk's scheduler
`GET/POST/PATCH /api/journal/setups`	setups
`GET /api/journal/stats` (filters)	every number of the page, computed in one place

5. When it fails

Event	What happens
an account's fetch fails	recorded with its reason; the account waits for its next turn; the sync's run record says which account failed
the journal is down	the desk is unaffected; the scheduler records the failed sync and alerts
a file has rows the parser cannot read	the import report lists every skipped row with its reason; nothing is dropped silently
the shared record is down	the snapshot waits and says so; trades still import

6. Built on

The old desk. legacy/journal/, documented from the code with every import format run on a scratch database:

- PAGE: every tab and formula;
- ACCOUNTS: the Alpaca accounts and their pairing;

- IMPORT: the file formats, and what was tested;
- ANALYSIS: the technical snapshot, conditions, grading;
- DATA-MODEL;
- OPERATIONS: start-up, the fetch timer, the tests;
- KNOWN-ISSUES: D-J1 to D-J20.

What failed there:

- **File imports mispaired scale-ins and scale-outs, lost TradingView shorts, and duplicated on re-import** (D-J1 to D-J7). Fixed by one engine (step 11).
- **No trade has a stop,** so every R is empty (D-J9).
- **Times were clock strings,** with a fixed −05:00 offset and one date per trade (D-J8, D-J10, D-J12). Fixed by real instants (step 4).
- **The snapshot and the grading half never worked** (D-J13, D-J14).
- **No fees for most sources** (D-J15).
- **The server's numbers differed from the page's** (D-J17).
- **None of the 84 journal tests covered the file importer.**

---

7. Status

Part	Status
the page and its formulas; Alpaca accounts on a schedule	**built** (legacy, kept)
real New York instants	**built** (step 4)
every broker file read as fills and paired by the one engine, with fees and a report of every row not read	**built** (step 11; D-J1 to D-J7)
stops; the entry snapshot from the shared record; MAE and MFE	**to build**
`accounts`, `fills`, `trade_fills` as tables; stable ids for files	**to build**
the sync started by the desk's scheduler	**to build** (step C). Today the journal runs its own minute timer
one condition system over the snapshot; setup statistics	**to build** (REVIEW.md)